Reading and writing

2026-12-11 | Week 8 | Use evidence to improve a design

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.7C

3.7C: Use text evidence to support an appropriate response. In plain English: Support an answer with something the text actually says or shows. Today: Explain a character's action using book evidence.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.9D(i)

4.9D(i): Recognize characteristics and structures of informational text, including: the central idea with supporting evidence. In plain English: Identify an informational text's central idea and the details that support it. Today: State the central idea and show supporting evidence.

I Do

Open the actual book to a prepared scene. State each grade's target above. Demonstrate the response routine with an unrelated example before the check. Keep the book open to the taught scene without giving the answer. Point to the exact illustration or sentence that makes the answer reasonable.

We Do

Give the book-based questions with planned access. Do not coach during the scored response. Return to the real page after acting. Ask the learner to show the book evidence, not just remember the prop.

You Do

Grade 3: Explain a character's action using book evidence. Grade 4: State the central idea and show supporting evidence. Ask a fresh question about a familiar bookmarked page. Accept the planned response mode and save the page/scene with the response.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match familiar props or photos from the already taught scene, sequence two mastered event photos, or use a known Vizzle task. Independent reading is not assumed.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Real books: A Chair for My Mother / Action Jackson. Bring the props and response mats in the weekly book guide.

Writing TEKS 3.7B

Write a response to a literary or informational text that demonstrates an understanding of a text.

Writing TEKS 4.7B

Write responses that demonstrate understanding of texts, including comparing and contrasting ideas across a variety of sources.

Writing and spelling

After the read-aloud, build one sentence from the evidence: Grade 3 states an opinion about helping and gives a reason; Grade 4 writes or dictates an informational fact about the artist. Keep HMH phonics/spelling at the assessed pattern; teach three words before Friday's spelling check. Writing TEKS 3.7B / 4.7B: compose a response to the actual text. Dictation or AAC composition is an access option; record the response method. Matching a picture alone is reading evidence, not independent written composition. For Grade 4, add an alike/different sentence comparing an idea in today's book with a previously read book; point to evidence in both sources.

Math

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Grade 3 | TEKS 3.3H

3.3H: Compare two fractions having the same numerator or denominator in problems by reasoning about their sizes and justifying the conclusion using symbols, words, objects, and pictorial models. In plain English: Compare fractions with the same numerator or denominator and justify which is greater. Today: Compare three fourths and one fourth; show which is larger and why.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.3A, 4.3B, 4.3E

4.3A: Represent a fraction a/b as a sum of fractions 1/b, where a and b are whole numbers and b > 0, including when a > b. In plain English: Build fractions, including amounts greater than one, by adding unit fractions. 4.3B: Decompose a fraction in more than one way into a sum of fractions with the same denominator using concrete and pictorial models and recording results with symbolic representations. In plain English: Break a fraction into same-denominator sums in more than one way; show models and equations. 4.3E: Represent and solve addition and subtraction of fractions with equal denominators using objects and pictorial models that build to the number line and properties of operations. In plain English: Model and solve fraction addition and subtraction with equal denominators. Today: Build a fresh like-denominator sum or difference; name one and one half from the model.

I Do

Grade 3: Use equal-length wholes to compare one half and one fourth. Point to the larger amount. Grade 4: Join one fourth and two fourths to make three fourths. Remove one fourth from three fourths. Build one whole plus one half.

We Do

Both students handle the shared materials. Practice one example with the teacher; then teach the two targets in separate rotations. Grade 4: build 3/4 as 1/4 + 1/4 + 1/4 and again as 1/4 + 2/4. Record both equations and explain why the same whole and denominator stay fixed.

You Do

Grade 3: Compare three fourths and one fourth; show which is larger and why. Grade 4: Build a fresh like-denominator sum or difference; name one and one half from the model.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Complete a mastered counting/sorting tray or known Bridges practice task at the student's established level.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Counters, plates/cups and the linked math mat. Select the matching grade-level STEMscopes lesson. Use Bridges placement to choose a separate foundational intervention.

Science

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Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8A, 3.8B

3.8A: Identify everyday examples of energy, including light, sound, thermal, and mechanical. In plain English: Recognize everyday examples of light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. 3.8B: Plan and conduct investigations that demonstrate how the speed of an object is related to its mechanical energy. In plain English: Plan and carry out a test connecting an object's speed to its mechanical energy. Today: Compare slow and faster runs of the same car; use the effect on a foam block to explain the relationship between speed and mechanical energy.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.7

4.7: Plan and conduct descriptive investigations to explore the patterns of forces such as gravity, friction, or magnetism in contact or at a distance on an object. In plain English: Plan and conduct investigations to find patterns in gravity, friction or magnetism. Today: Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism.

I Do

Repeat smooth and felt track trials; use evidence to select a track design.

We Do

Complete three trials. Record prediction and observed result. Use the Friday science tasks to assess during the investigation. Grade 3: plan two releases of the same car, one slow and one faster, into the same lightweight foam block. Keep the car, block, surface and collision point fixed; reset the block and repeat three trials per condition. Record observed speed and how far the block moves. Use the greater observed effect as evidence about mechanical energy; do not use travel distance alone as a speed measurement.

You Do

Grade 3: Demonstrate the tested change and communicate one observation. Grade 4: Show friction, magnetic attraction or gravity using observed evidence.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Sort familiar object/photo matches away from the experiment station. Experiments are adult supervised.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Toy car, board, felt, ramp, tape, fraction strips, project board, curriculum history pictures. Adult manages circuit parts, magnets, small items and warm materials; use a low-voltage kit only.

Friday investigation

Design-and-test lab: reuse the familiar ramp setup. Grade 3 demonstrates a motion/energy finding (3.8B). Grade 4 tests smooth and textured surfaces for a friction pattern (4.7). Make one planned change, repeat three times, and use a photo or model to explain the evidence. Grade 3 uses the same car and foam block for slow/faster trials, resets the block each time and compares the effects. Grade 4 changes only the track surface for the friction comparison.

Social studies

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Grade 3 | TEKS 3.1A

3.1A: Describe how individuals, events, and ideas have changed communities, past and present. In plain English: Explain how people, events and ideas have changed communities. Today: Show a community problem, action and result.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.3E

4.3E: Explain the events that led to the annexation of Texas to the United States and the impact of the U.S.-Mexican War. In plain English: Explain how Texas became part of the United States and the effects of the U.S.-Mexican War. Today: Explain how a Republic event connects to statehood.

I Do

Grade 3: Show a community problem, action and result. Model with one district source, naming the visible clue. Grade 4: Explain how a Republic event connects to statehood. Use the current Texas history map, image or excerpt; name the person/event and point to the evidence.

We Do

Work together with a second example from the same source set. One visual source, one placement, one explanation. Keep the grade-specific question visible and fade added hints.

You Do

Grade 3: Show a community problem, action and result. Grade 4: Explain how a Republic event connects to statehood. Use a fresh source/card; accept a model, pointing, AAC or a spoken explanation.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match two familiar source pictures or complete a known picture-to-object task.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

District source pictures or excerpts, two-event sequence mat and writing/history frames. The classroom texts do not replace Texas history sources.